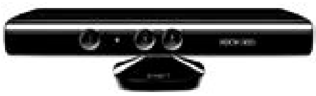
New way to pay
MasterCard unveiled a service called PayPass wallet that allows user purchases to be made with a single click or tap **http://dgit.in/Jdb3eB**

Small and fast
Transcend launched MSA720 SATA III SSD weighing just 7 grams and 1/8 the size of a standard 2.5" SSD. Will be available in 64 GB and 128 GB

Microsoft's Garage Science Fair in India

In its third year the fair encourages company employees to innovate in their spare time. This year, it showcased roughly 60 projects, including a few for speech and visually impaired folks. Kinectacles and Kinect Bridge were two such projects. The Kinectacles prototype pointed towards a future in which a Kinect PCB (printed circuit board) and speakers would be integrated into camera-based specs using the platform's 3D motion sensing technology to help guide the visually-impaired.



The Kinectacles prototype

Kinect Bridge, aimed at the speech and *visually* impaired, would use the Kinect motion sensor to interpret sign language and body gestures, converting them into text or voice. It will be meant for both, Windows and Xbox platforms.

Vu 3D camera launched in India, at ₹19,990

Vu Technologies has launched the Vu 3D camera in India, priced at ₹19,990. It's available at Vu stores across the country. It features dual lens-dual sensor (DLDS) technology (two 16MP sensors), allowing it to capture stereoscopic images. Interestingly, the Vu 3D camera also has a 3.2-inch autostereoscopic LCD display (320x480), not requiring glasses.

Users can connect the Vu 3D camera directly to an HDTV, via its HDMI port. It features 128 MB of built-in storage, which can be expanded by up to 32GB via an SD card slot. This may not be enough considering that these are HD and 3D movies talking about. Optical zoom in 3D mode is up to 8X, while in 2D mode, it's up to 10X.

The VU 3D camera

The Vu 3D camera features a F3.2 lens with a 5.1mm focal length, and records video in H.264 (avi) format. It can record 720p HD video at 60fps in 3D and 2D, and, full 1080p HD video at 30fps in 2D and 3D. It takes 3D still images in 2M, 5M and 16M (firmware interpolation) sizes, and 2D still images in 2M, 5M, 8M and 16M (firmware interpolation) sizes. You can also enjoy live streaming in 3D and 2D of your favourite videos.

Vu Technologies is one more company that has joined the 3D camera race but it most definitely is the first of its kind in India. We can expect to see a lot more competition in this space very soon considering that conversion of 2D to 3D on a conventional 3D TV doesn't manage to give you a real 3D effect. The Vu camera effectively bridges this gap since it can capture 3D HD videos right at the source so there's no hassle of having to convert to 3D.

Toshiba VL20 3D Smart-TV series launched in India, starting ₹75,990

Toshiba India has launched its first full HD 3D Smart-TV in India, called the Toshiba VL20 LED Power TV, in two screen sizes – 40 inch (₹75,990 - MRP) and 46 inch (₹85,990 - MRP). The Toshiba VL20 LED Power TV features a slim 17mm silver-coloured bezel, and slim swivel stand design. One set of Toshiba 3D glasses are bundled along with the 3DTV.

The 'smart' part of the Toshiba VL20 3D Smart-TV comes from the host of interactive content available on the internet, and on the TV, via TV apps from the Toshiba Places store (featuring Music Place, Video Place, Game Place, News Place and Social Place). The line-up of 3D Smart-TVs features Dolby Digital, MHL technology, wireless LAN (via USB dongle), DLNA, as well as two USB ports – one HDMI port, a PC port, composite and component ports, and digital audio ports. The Toshiba VL20 3D Smart-TV series is powered by the REGZA engine, and comes with ClearScan 100 Pro, 2D to 3D Conversion, 10-bit video processing power for 10-bit quality of input data, over 1 billion colours thereby, and 3D Color Management, for automatic adjustment of hue, saturation and colour brightness without affecting the other colours, providing more natural looking pictures. Has an Auto Signal Booster, and AutoView features.

Toshiba VL20 3D Smart TV